

Parent Guide — senior / module-01- what-is-iks

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Parent Guide — Module 1 (Senior): What is IKS?

Your student's age: Senior (Grades 9–12) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 45 min

What your student is learning

This is an introductory but rigorous module on Indian intellectual history:

- The canonical structure of Indian Knowledge Systems — 4 Vedas, 4 layers within each, 6 Vedāṅgas, 4 Upavedas, 6 darśanas (philosophical schools).
- **Primary-source reading** — Ṛg Veda 1.1, Īśa Upaniṣad, one Aryabhata verse — in IAST with translation.
- **Specific intellectual achievements** — Pāṇini's grammar, Mādhava's infinite series, Sushruta's surgery, Aryabhata's earth-rotation, the Yavana (Greek-Indian) exchange.
- **The contemporary policy debate** — NEP 2020 §4.6 on integrating IKS into mainstream education. Three positions taken seriously: integration, separation, qualified integration.
- **A 5–6 page research paper** on a specific IKS claim, with primary, scholarly, and comparative sources.

What's at stake

Your student will engage these honest framings:

- **“IKS” as a single category is recent (post-2000).** The intellectual traditions it groups are ancient. The label is newer. This matters for clear thinking.
- **Real achievements deserve specific credit.** Pāṇini's grammar (~4th c. BCE), Mādhava's π series (~14th c. CE), Sushruta's surgery (~6th c. BCE) — named, dated, defensible.
- **Some popular claims overreach.** “Vedic mathematics” (Module 5) is 20th-century, not Vedic. “Indians knew everything first” is triumphalism, not history. Your student learns to push back fairly.

Policy debate (Day 7)

Three positions, taken seriously:

1. **Integration:** IKS should be taught alongside modern science. (NEP §4.6.)

2. **Separation:** IKS belongs in humanities/history class; modern science class should focus on the scientific method.
3. **Qualified integration:** Historical context yes; equivalent scientific validity no.

All three have scholarly defenders. Your student will steel-man all three before forming their own view.

How to help

Helpful: - Read NEP §4.6 yourself; discuss with your student. - Recommend a scholarly book: Plofker, Wujastyk, Pollock. - For the paper: be a thoughtful skeptic.

Not helpful: - Push them toward a “correct” position on the policy debate. The point is informed engagement. - Insist that all claims about IKS are equally valid OR equally false.

What success looks like

By end of module, your student can: - Read a Vedic verse in IAST with translation and discuss it. - Name 3+ specific Indian intellectual achievements with dates and authors. - Steel-man all three policy positions. - Write a research paper that holds historical context and modern scientific standards together.

Want to go further?

- Plofker, K. (2009). *Mathematics in India*. Princeton.
- Pollock, S. (2006). *The Language of the Gods in the World of Men*. California.
- Lloyd & Sivin (2002). *The Way and the Word*. Yale. (Comparative.)

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 1 (Senior) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

Day	Title	File
1	“IKS”: What does the term refer to?	days/day-01-hook.md
2	Vedic corpus — close reading	days/day-02-vedic-reading.md
3	Six darśanas	days/day-03-darshanas.md
4	Indian Mathematics specifics	days/day-04-mathematics.md
5	Mid-module + paper topic	days/day-05-mid-module.md
6	Astronomy + Yavana exchange	days/day-06-astronomy.md

Day	Title	File
7	Policy debate	days/day-07-policy-debate.md
8	Project Session 1	days/day-08-project-session-1.md
9	Project Session 2	days/day-09-project-session-2.md
10	Final + paper	days/day-10-final-assessment.md

Pacing

- Day 2 needs quiet reading time — schedule when class is fresh.
- Day 7 debate can run long — book buffer.

What students leave with

- The IKS map at scholarly depth.
- Primary source reading skill (Sanskrit + IAST).
- A defensible position on the policy debate.
- One research paper.

Homework

Homework — Module 1 (Senior)

Day	Task	Time
1 → 2	Read NEP §4.6. Note 2 ambiguities.	30 min
2 → 3	Read 5 more verses of Īśa Upaniṣad in translation.	30 min
3 → 4	Read brief intro to one darśana (your choice).	30 min
4 → 5	Compute 100 terms of Madhava's π series; how close?	20 min
5 → 6	Submit paper plan: thesis + 3 sources.	30 min
6 → 7	Choose debate position; prepare 3-min argument + 1 steel-manned counter.	45 min
7 → 8	Draft 1 page of paper.	60 min

Day	Task	Time
8 → 9	Continue drafting (2+ pages by tomorrow).	60 min
9 → 10	Complete and proofread.	60 min